EMPANADA DE CARNE ARGENTINA

YIELD	ACTIVE TIME	REST	OVEN
Filling for 1 large empanada (or about 12 individual ones)	**15 min**	**Overnight (chill before assembling)**	**200 °C, about 25 min**

ENERGY COST
$1.89 (25 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)

INGREDIENTS

600 g	Minced beef
3	Large onions, finely chopped
2	Hard-boiled eggs, chopped
12	Green olives, pitted and cut into pieces
1 tsp	Ground cumin
1 tsp	Sweet pimentón (plus a pinch of hot)
1 tsp	Oregano
no quantity given	Salt and pepper
3 tbsp	Oil (or fat)
if needed	Stock

METHOD

1. Sweat the onion in oil over medium heat until translucent and soft. Do not let it brown.
2. Raise the heat, add the beef and break it up until it loses its red colour.
3. Season with cumin, pimentón, oregano, salt and pepper. Add a little stock if it runs dry.
4. Off the heat, cool completely — ideally overnight in the fridge.
5. Fold in the chopped egg and olives just before assembling.
6. Fill, seal with a repulgue and bake at 200 °C for about 25 min until golden.

NOTES

Stovetop cook time is 20 min.
Resting the filling cold overnight is the Argentine trick. The flavour settles and it handles better.
Cumin is the aroma that defines an empanada criolla. Do not leave it out.
Lots of onion relative to the meat is what keeps it juicy.
Egg and olives go in at the end, not while cooking, so they stay whole.
Some cooks add raisins for the traditional sweet-savoury note.
Filling always goes on cold.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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